

F422

R

SECRETARY SHULTZ OF-EO-PIECE:

THE REYKJAVIK MEETING

The Reykjavik meeting between President Reagan and General Secretary Gorbachev was an extraordinary event. Far more was achieved than anyone had considered possible beforehand. If the Soviets are as prepared as we to follow through on the work done last week, Reykjavik could set the stage for a major advance in U.S.-Soviet relations, one that could potentially transform the international security landscape. In Reykjavik, we drew within sight of a major goal of this Administration -- achieving the reduction and eventual elimination of the danger posed by nuclear weapons.

Of course we were disappointed by the way the meeting ended. That was hardly surprising. For a few heady hours, a truly historic outcome seemed within our grasp. It was hard to have to walk away from that. But the President was prepared to do so rather than compromise his conscience and the security of this country and our Allies.

Here's what we achieved in two days of substantive, intense, but civil discussions:

Human rights, as we had promised, were front and center in Iceland. Perhaps never before have the U.S. government and interested groups and individuals in this country cooperated so extensively and effectively in preparing for such a meeting. In Reykjavik, the President drew heavily on materials provided by the National Council on Soviet Jewry and other organizations in his discussions with the General Secretary. It made for a strong and convincing presentation. We believe the Soviets will consider it carefully. We hope it will have an impact in the months ahead.

We made real progress on bilateral issues. We agreed on an ambitious work plan for expanding contacts between our two societies. It provided for intensive negotiations over the months ahead on space cooperation, multilateral cooperation in nuclear fusion research, and improving cooperation in maritime search and rescue between our two countries. The two leaders endorsed this work and we are operating on the assumption that the schedule we outlined remains valid.

There was a wide-ranging discussion of regional problems in Reykjavik. It is in the nature of these issues that we disagreed more than we agreed; and we put down some strong markers on the impact on our relations of Soviet behavior in such places as Afghanistan and Central America. But one thing we did agree on was the utility of continuing to compare and exchange views on these issues, and to find common ground where we can. We expect to continue the regional dialogue in the months ahead.

DEPARTMENT OF STATE

REVIEWED by

Date

() EXCISE

() EXCISE

() DENY

() DENY

() EXCISE

REASON FOR EXCISE

TS authorized

() DOWNGRADE TS to () S or () C, OADR

DECLASSIFIED

And of course we discussed arms control. This was no ordinary dialogue. Both the President and General Secretary demonstrated themselves to be men of vision, capable of taking bold and creative decisions on the spot. Those decisions brought us very close to concluding understandings on dramatic reductions of strategic offensive weapons, on the virtual elimination of longer range INF missiles, and on a nuclear test regime that would protect our vital interests.

The two leaders discussed strategic defense at great length. The President did his utmost to demonstrate that the Soviets have nothing to fear from SDI, even offering to postpone deployment of a strategic defense system for ten years. He assured them that, during that period, we would continue to abide strictly by the ABM Treaty.

It was unfortunate that this was not enough for the Soviets, who insisted that we had to "strengthen" the ABM Treaty by agreeing to a ban on any testing of SDI-related activities outside the laboratory. This went well beyond what we -- and the Soviets -- had agreed to when the Treaty was signed in 1972. Although we were assured this was not the Soviet intention, it was clear that the effect would have been to kill the Strategic Defense Initiative. This the President could not accept. He would not abandon a program that has brought our arms control dialogue so far, and that would be critical in ensuring compliance with reductions we might ultimately agree to. That was a decision that took vision and courage, and this President has both qualities in abundance.

In walking away from a quick deal in Reykjavik, have we reached the end of the road? Hardly. We have said we are prepared to build on the work done there and during the months that preceded the meeting. Our negotiators are on their way back to Geneva to follow up on the discussions between the President and the General Secretary. The issues are clearer now. We have cut through much of the underbrush in the path of agreements. We are ready to push ahead with the rest of the agenda as well.

In his public statements since Reykjavik, General Secretary Gorbachev has said that his meeting with the President was not in vain. We could not agree more. The real significance of Reykjavik is that we got so close. Serious work lies ahead. The United States is ready.

DECLASSIFIED